# Ideation Phase

## Empathize & Discover

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| **Date** | 24 October 2026 |
| **Team ID** | |
| **Project Name** | Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow |
| **Maximum Marks** | 4 Marks |

## Empathy Map Canvas

An empathy map is a one-page view of what a user sees, hears, says, does, thinks and feels, together with the pains they face and the gains they want. It helps the team understand the problem from the user's side before the solution is designed.

This map is built around the **Service Desk Agent**, the person who records, classifies, assigns and follows incidents in ServiceNow. The agent in this project is Beth Anglin.

### User Profile

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| **Role** | Service Desk Agent handling incoming IT incidents. |
| **Goal** | Take each incident from creation to the right resolver group quickly, with complete and correct records. |
| **Daily tasks** | Creating incidents, classifying them, using Agent Assist knowledge, assigning groups, updating work notes and tracking SLAs. |
| **Works with** | Callers such as Michael Hoefer, Level 2 technicians such as David Loo, watchers such as Samantha Bordwell, knowledge articles and change requests. |
| **Main challenge** | Incomplete details, unclear ownership after reassignment, repeated troubleshooting and SLAs that are hard to watch. |
| **Success looks like** | The right group assigned first time, a known fix reused, and a clear record kept for the next incident. |

### Example Scenario

Michael Hoefer calls to say he cannot connect to the Corporate VPN from home. He connected yesterday evening, but this morning he receives an authentication error, and his internet works fine. Beth creates the incident, classifies it as Network > VPN with urgency 2 - Medium, attaches a helpful knowledge article through Agent Assist, adds watchers and reassigns the incident to the Network group. The steps below show what she sees, hears, says, does, thinks and feels along the way.

## Empathy Map: Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

**User: Service Desk Agent (Beth Anglin)**

| **SEES** | **HEARS** |
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| • The new incident form with caller, category, subcategory, urgency, service and CI fields<br>• Knowledge articles suggested by Agent Assist from the short description<br>• The Related Records tab with Task SLAs, child incidents and change requests<br>• The Assigned to field clearing after the group changes | • Caller: "I connected last night, but this morning I get an authentication error."<br>• Caller: "My internet works fine, only the VPN fails."<br>• Level 2 team: "Please link this to the change request."<br>• Colleagues and leads asking for an update on the incident and its SLA |
| **SAYS** | **DOES** |
| • "Can you tell me the exact error you see?"<br>• "I am assigning this to the Network group."<br>• "Please follow the steps in this knowledge article."<br>• "I have added a watcher so you will get updates." | • Creates the incident in Service Operations Workspace<br>• Sets Network > VPN, urgency, Remote Access service, Corporate VPN offering and CI<br>• Marks the knowledge article helpful and attaches it with a comment<br>• Adds the watch list and work notes list, then reassigns to Network |
| **THINKS** | **FEELS** |
| • Is this classified correctly so it reaches the right team?<br>• Is there already a known fix I can attach?<br>• Who owns this once it is reassigned?<br>• Will the SLA be missed if this waits? | • Worried about missing details while the caller waits<br>• Frustrated when the same troubleshooting is repeated<br>• Uncertain about ownership after reassignment<br>• Relieved when the fix is documented and can be reused |
| **PAINS** | **GAINS** |
| • Incomplete or inconsistent incident details<br>• Wrong category or urgency sends the incident to the wrong place<br>• Reassignment delays and unclear ownership<br>• Same troubleshooting repeated for similar issues<br>• SLAs, change requests and child incidents are hard to track<br>• Resolution not documented at closure | • Consistent classification on every incident<br>• Right group assigned first time<br>• Knowledge reused through Agent Assist<br>• SLA and related records visible on the incident<br>• Cause, resolution and a knowledge article recorded<br>• Fewer follow-up calls from callers |

## Key Insights from the Empathy Map

The table links what the Service Desk Agent experiences to what the incident lifecycle automation provides.

| Area | What the agent experiences | What the project provides |
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| Incident creation | Details are missing or written differently each time. | A new incident form in Service Operations Workspace with caller, short description and assignment group. |
| Classification | Category, urgency and service are chosen inconsistently. | Category, subcategory, urgency, service, service offering and CI set on every incident. |
| Knowledge | The same troubleshooting is repeated for similar issues. | Agent Assist suggests articles, which can be marked helpful and attached. |
| Reassignment | Ownership is unclear after the group changes. | Reassignment to the Network group, Assigned to cleared, watch list and work notes list added. |
| Change handling | A needed change is hard to connect to the incident. | An emergency change request created from and linked to the incident. |
| Recurring issues | Repeat reports are handled separately. | Child incidents linked to the parent incident. |
| Resolution | Cause and resolution are skipped at closure. | Probable cause, resolution code and resolution notes recorded, then the incident resolved. |
| SLA and knowledge | SLA timers are hard to watch and fixes are not reused. | Task SLAs visible in Related Records and a knowledge article created from the incident. |

## Key Takeaways

- The agent's biggest worry is acting on incomplete information, so the first steps must capture and classify the right details.
- Unclear ownership after reassignment causes delay, so accurate assignment and clear watchers are a high priority.
- Repeated troubleshooting wastes time, so knowledge articles and related incidents must be easy to find and reuse.
- SLA status must be visible on the incident so the agent can act before a target is missed.
- A complete cause and resolution record, and a new knowledge article, reduce follow-up calls and help future incidents.

## How This Supports the Project

The empathy map shows that problems appear at every stage of the incident lifecycle, not in one place. The ServiceNow implementation therefore covers the whole path: record creation, classification, knowledge integration, reassignment and escalation, change request creation, child incident creation, resolution, knowledge creation, and SLA and related-record validation.